Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Acceptable Use Plan



2026-2027

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This document outlines the East Newark Public School's comprehensive plan for the acceptable use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools. Developed in conjunction with Board Policy 2365 – "Acceptable Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI)," this plan provides detailed guidelines and provisions to ensure AI is integrated responsibly and effectively within our educational environment. Our aim is to leverage AI to enhance learning experiences while upholding academic integrity, fostering critical thinking, and promoting digital citizenship among students and faculty.

East Newark Public School does not endorse any specific AI company or product, but may offer examples of AI tools for illustrative purposes throughout this document.

Questions regarding this manual should be directed to the district AI Coordinator, Dr. Rosaura Bagolie.

Foundational AI Terms and Concepts

For a comprehensive overview of essential AI terms, concepts, and resources, the New Jersey Department of Education provides a dedicated website on Artificial Intelligence, accessible here: Artificial Intelligence (AI).

In alignment with Board Policy 2365 – "Acceptable Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI)," this plan will utilize the following key terms:

- **"AI tools"**: Refers to software applications and platforms that employ AI technologies to perform specific tasks and solve problems that typically necessitate human intelligence. Examples include generative text models, image generators, and advanced data analysis tools.
- **"Assignment"**: Encompasses any task, project, or work required of a student as an integral part of their educational and co-curricular program within the district.

Goals and Advantages of AI in Education

East Newark Public School is committed to harnessing the power of artificial intelligence to enhance educational experiences while maintaining a strong ethical foundation. By fostering an environment where AI is used thoughtfully, we aim to empower educators to innovate and support our students' learning journey while safeguarding their privacy, equity, and well-being.

Goals for Implementing AI in Education

The integration of AI in education at East Newark Public School is guided by the following objectives:

1. Maximize student achievement.
2. Increase efficiency and productivity in educational tasks for both students and staff.
3. Ensure equitable access to teaching and learning resources.

4. Strengthen communication channels between parents and teachers.
5. Optimize the integration of smart technology in an educational setting.
6. Foster professional collaboration among educators.
7. Enhance personalized learning experiences for students.
8. Promote instructional consistency across the district.

Advantages of Using AI in Education

Thoughtful and responsible use of AI can offer significant benefits to the educational process:

- Decrease the time spent analyzing, synthesizing, and evaluating student data.
- Reduce time in planning for lessons and creating instructional materials.
- Facilitate the creation of formative assessments.
- Develop tools and resources that generate immediate feedback for students.
- Generate activities that promote higher-order critical thinking and problem-solving skills.

Authorized Use by Grade Level and Department

As AI continues to advance, its thoughtful integration into education is crucial. This integration must enhance learning experiences while rigorously upholding academic integrity and promoting responsible digital citizenship. The following framework guides teachers in supporting students' appropriate use of AI in various assignments and activities across all grade levels and subject areas.

Authorized Use by Grade Level

- **Grades K-5: Limited AI Use**
  - AI tool usage is permitted in a highly controlled and supervised manner, primarily to enrich learning experiences without undermining the development of foundational skills (e.g., basic writing, arithmetic).
  - Introduction to fundamental digital literacy and basic AI concepts should occur through age-appropriate, interactive activities.
- **Grades 6-8: Broader AI Use**
  - AI tools may be integrated into selected subjects and assignments/activities to further enhance learning and explore new methodologies.
  - Digital literacy skills will be expanded upon, with a strong emphasis on the ethical implications of AI use, understanding its limitations, proper source citation, and maintaining academic integrity.

Department/Subject Area Considerations

Specific courses and departments may integrate AI into their curriculum and instructional practices as deemed beneficial and appropriate. Examples include:

- **Digital Citizenship, Digital Newsroom, Computer Applications, STEAM and Other Computer-Based Electives**: AI tools may be seamlessly integrated into curriculum and instructional practices for purposes such as research, digital literacy development, coding, data analysis, technological exploration, and media creation.
- **Special Services**: AI tools can serve as valuable accommodations in alignment with a student's Individualized Education Program (IEP) or 504 Plan. This supports diverse student learning needs and enhances accessibility.
- **English Language Learners**: AI tools may also be used as accommodations for multilingual learners to make instruction more accessible, in accordance with documented WIDA level support requirements. The selection and implementation of AI tools for these purposes will be determined collaboratively by the student's educational team and regularly reviewed for effectiveness and alignment with learning targets.
- **Pilot Programs**: AI tools may be introduced experimentally in designated pilot programs, with prior administrative approval, to evaluate their effectiveness and potential for broader implementation across the district.

Crucially, AI usage at all levels must primarily serve educational purposes and align directly with district curriculum standards and learning objectives. Its role is to complement, support, and enrich the adopted courses of study, not to replace core learning or independent effort.

Authorized Use of AI for Students

Student utilization of artificial intelligence tools in assignments is permitted exclusively with the explicit authorization of teachers within their respective courses or for specific assignments. Any submission of content generated through AI without appropriate permission and proper attribution may be considered a violation of the academic integrity policy 5701.

AI Assessment Scale

This most recent AI Assessment Scale (AIAS) created by Dr. Leon Furze, is designed to be versatile and adaptable across different subjects and types of assessments. It can be used for various AI tools, whether they are for generating or editing images, or for creating text, like ChatGPT. The scale can be applied to tasks that involve producing original content, such as writing essays or making artwork, as well as tasks focused on research, summarizing, and combining information, whether or not those tasks involve AI tools connected to the internet. This flexibility makes it easy for teachers to implement a wide range of classroom activities.

The district will implement this **"AI Traffic Light" model** to clearly communicate expectations regarding AI use. This model should be readily accessible to students and faculty.

NOTE: The default setting for all assignments is RED unless a teacher explicitly provides alternative permission.

Traffic Light	Definition	Purpose
RED (No AI Use)	**AI Use is NOT Permitted**	Students **must not use any AI tools** for this assignment. This level ensures that students rely solely on their knowledge, understanding, and skills. All work must be original and completed independently. Using AI in any capacity for "RED" assignments will be considered a violation of academic integrity. The purpose of "RED" assignments is to assess students' unaided knowledge, skills, and understanding, fostering critical thinking, independent problem-solving, and foundational skill development without reliance on AI.
YELLOW (Conditional AI Use)	**AI Use is Permitted with Strict Conditions**	Students **may use AI tools only under specific, predefined conditions** outlined by the teacher for a particular assignment. This might include using AI for brainstorming ideas, creating structures, and generating ideas for improving work (no AI content allowed in the final submission). Making improvements to the clarity or quality of student-created work to improve the final output (no new content can be created using AI). Proofreading for grammar and spelling (but not substantive editing or rewriting). Summarizing complex texts (with required verification of accuracy and proper citation). Students **must clearly document and attribute all AI usage** as specified by the teacher, demonstrating how the AI was used to *support* their learning process, not to replace it. Failure to adhere to conditions and/or properly attribute AI use will result in academic penalties. The purpose of "YELLOW" assignments is to teach students how to responsibly and ethically interact with AI as a learning aid, developing critical evaluation skills and understanding the limitations of AI-generated content.
GREEN (Encouraged AI Use)	**AI Use is Fully Permitted and Encouraged**	Students **are encouraged to utilize AI tools** for this assignment to explore, innovate, and enhance their work, with the explicit understanding that they remain responsible for the final output's accuracy, integrity, and originality. This may include using AI for completing specified tasks, with students providing discussion or commentary on the AI-generated content (requires critical engagement and evaluation of AI output). Acting as a 'co-pilot' to meet assessment requirements, allowing for a collaborative approach with AI and enhancing creativity. Generating creative content or

		initial drafts. Synthesizing information from multiple sources.Data analysis and visualization. Developing code or programming solutions. Exploring complex concepts and generating different perspectives. Students are still **required to cite and document their AI usage** in detail, reflecting on how AI contributed to their learning and the final product. The purpose of "GREEN" assignments is to empower students to leverage AI as a powerful tool for advanced learning, research, and creation, promoting critical thinking about AI's capabilities and limitations, and preparing them for future academic and professional environments where AI is prevalent.

The concepts for these levels are informed by the AI Assessment Scale created by Dr. Leon Furze.

Authorized Use of AI Tools for Faculty

Faculty members are encouraged to prioritize district-approved curriculum resources and district-purchased tools when integrating AI. Exploration of additional AI tools beyond district-approved resources is permissible in consultation with administration, ensuring alignment with district policies and fostering collaborative decision-making.

Expectations of Using AI in Education for Faculty

All faculty members utilizing AI tools must adhere to the following expectations:

1. Teachers & Staff must use AI for educational purposes outlined in this document.
2. Teachers & Staff must not share identifiable student data with AI resources.
3. Always check the reliability of information/data by verifying resources – "Trust but Verify."
4. Teachers & Staff shall participate in sharing feedback experiences in using AI to inform future Professional Development during Professional Learning Communities.
5. Teachers shall demonstrate consistency across content areas and/or grade levels regarding AI use policies.

Personally Identifiable Information and Confidentiality:

- Never share any personally identifiable student information, including but not limited to names, addresses, birthdates, social security numbers, medical records, or any other sensitive data, with any AI chatbot or tool.
- Maintain strict confidentiality and uphold student privacy at all times when interacting with AI tools or discussing AI-generated content.

Curriculum Alignment and Appropriateness:

- All lesson content, activities, and materials incorporating AI must be aligned with the district curriculum, appropriate for the age and developmental stage of the students, and

meet the New Jersey Student Learning Standards (NJSLS) for the relevant grade level and content area.
- Faculty must regularly review AI-generated outputs for accuracy, fairness, and potential bias. Avoid sole reliance on AI-generated content; ensure it is thoroughly vetted, fact-checked, and critically evaluated before integration into instructional materials or activities.

Concerns:

- If a parent, student, or fellow faculty member raises a concern regarding AI content or materials used in instruction, promptly discuss the matter with your direct supervisor to address it appropriately.

Professional Development for AI in Education

East Newark Public School is committed to providing ongoing professional development to ensure all teachers and staff are equipped to effectively and ethically integrate AI into their educational practices.

Professional Development Structure

The district will provide opportunities for ongoing professional development, which may include attending workshops and receiving support from district coaches.

- The district encourages teachers to become **AI trainers** and explore resources such as the **NJEA AI Trainer Certification Course** available at https://www.njea.org/ai-trainer-certification-course/, as well as **webinars** available through Pedagogy Futures at https://pedagogyfutures.io/pd/.
- Professional development will be aligned with the following categories:

Equity & Communication	**Planning & Assessment**	**Differentiation & Support**
Example: Use AI-generated graphics to ensure images depicted in your lessons are appropriate and reflect diverse learning environments. Example: Generate or revise emails to send to parents/guardians.	Prompt examples: Acting as a 3rd grade teacher, generate a 40-minute lesson plan on [topic] in [subject] that includes group discussion, conferencing time, and independent work time. Acting as a kindergarten teacher, take a look at this lesson plan and provide several question	Example: Personalized support, such as AI tutors that provide on-demand explanations of concepts. Example: Create a notes/organization sheet for my ML students to practice these skills for [copy-paste lesson/activity/class].

Example: Use a dataset for individual students to analyze and generate a summary for parent/teacher conferences.	ideas for the closure of the lesson. Generate a lesson plan for PE class, creating a new game involving elements of soccer, basketball, and tennis.	

The use of AI by students will be guided by procedures reviewed and approved by school administrators. Lesson plans will be monitored to ensure that AI is integrated appropriately and in alignment with instructional goals and district policies.

Suspected Academic Dishonesty Using AI

A teacher who suspects that a student has misused AI in an assignment should follow these steps for initial review:

Step 1: Gather Evidence

- **Review Assignment Instructions:** Re-examine the assignment instructions shared with the student/class to clarify the permitted level of AI use for that specific task.
- **Submission History:** Check the submission and revision history within any relevant digital platforms used for assignments, if applicable, to observe the evolution of the student's work.
- **AI Detection Tool Results:** Utilize results from an AI detection tool (note: AI detection tools are not foolproof and should be used as one piece of evidence, not definitive proof).
- **Compare Student Work:** Review previous student writing samples or work for inconsistencies in writing style, complexity, or typical errors.
- **Compare to AI-Generated Response:** Generate an AI response to the exact assignment prompt and compare it to the student's work to identify any direct copying, extensive paraphrasing, or structural similarities.

Step 2: Initiate a Conversation with the Student

- Approach the student in a non-accusatory and supportive manner. The goal is to understand their process and promote learning.
- Ask open-ended questions to encourage reflection on their work and any AI use. Examples:
  - "Can you walk me through how you completed this assignment?"
  - "What resources did you use during your research and writing process?"
  - "Did you integrate any AI tools into your workflow? If so, how did you use them?"
  - "What was your thought process behind [specific section/idea]?"

Step 3: Assess the Extent of AI Use

- Based on the evidence gathered and the student's explanation, assess the level and nature of AI assistance. Determine if the use was within permitted guidelines, or if it constitutes a violation of academic integrity.

Step 4: Next Steps

- If a violation is suspected or confirmed, refer to other relevant district policies, regulations, and procedures as necessary, including but not limited to:
    - Policy 2361 - Acceptable Use of Computer Network/Computers and Resources
    - Policy 5701 - Academic Integrity
    - Policy 5600 - Student Discipline/Code of Conduct

Violations of Policy 2365

In instances where a student is accused of violating Policy 2365 – "Acceptable Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI)" or this accompanying AI Plan, the school will strictly adhere to the provisions outlined in **Policy and Regulation 5600 –Student Discipline/Code of Conduct** before making any final determination regarding the student's conduct or imposing disciplinary actions.

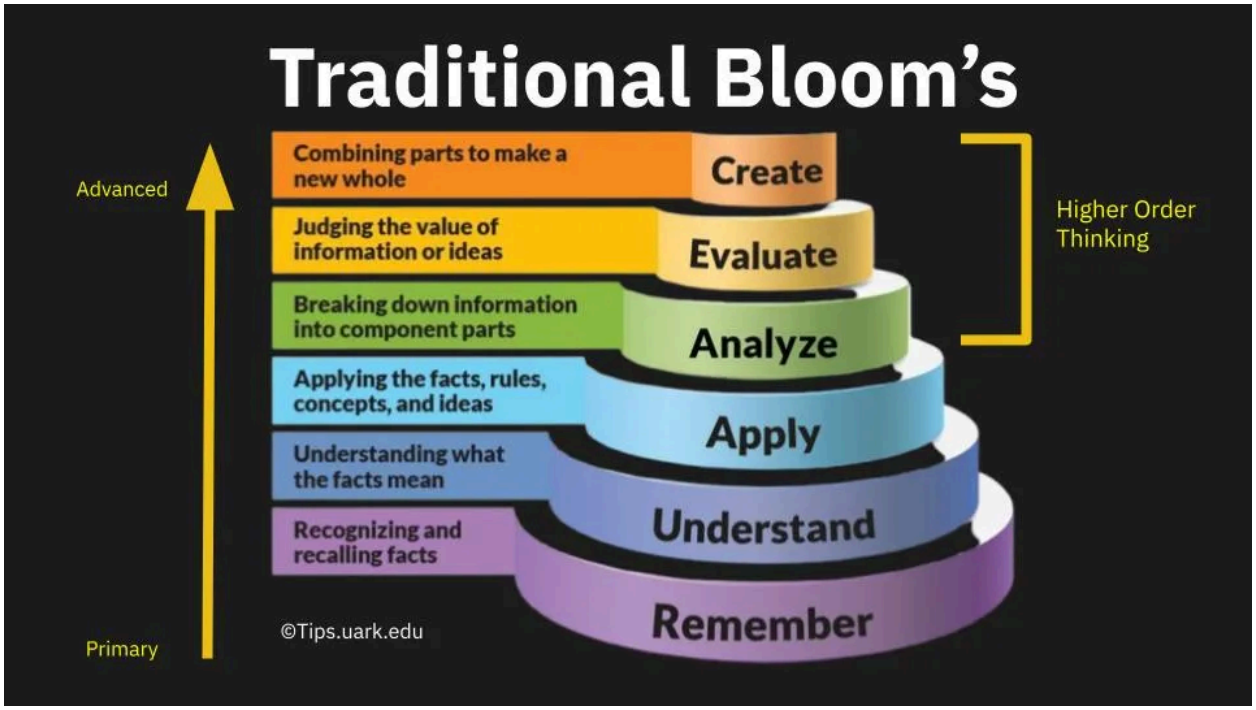
AI Attribution

Students are required to cite AI-generated content used in their assignments. Citation should follow either the Modern Language Association (MLA) Style, American Psychological Association (APA) Style, or Chicago Manual of Style, based on their teacher's specific preference for the course or assignment.

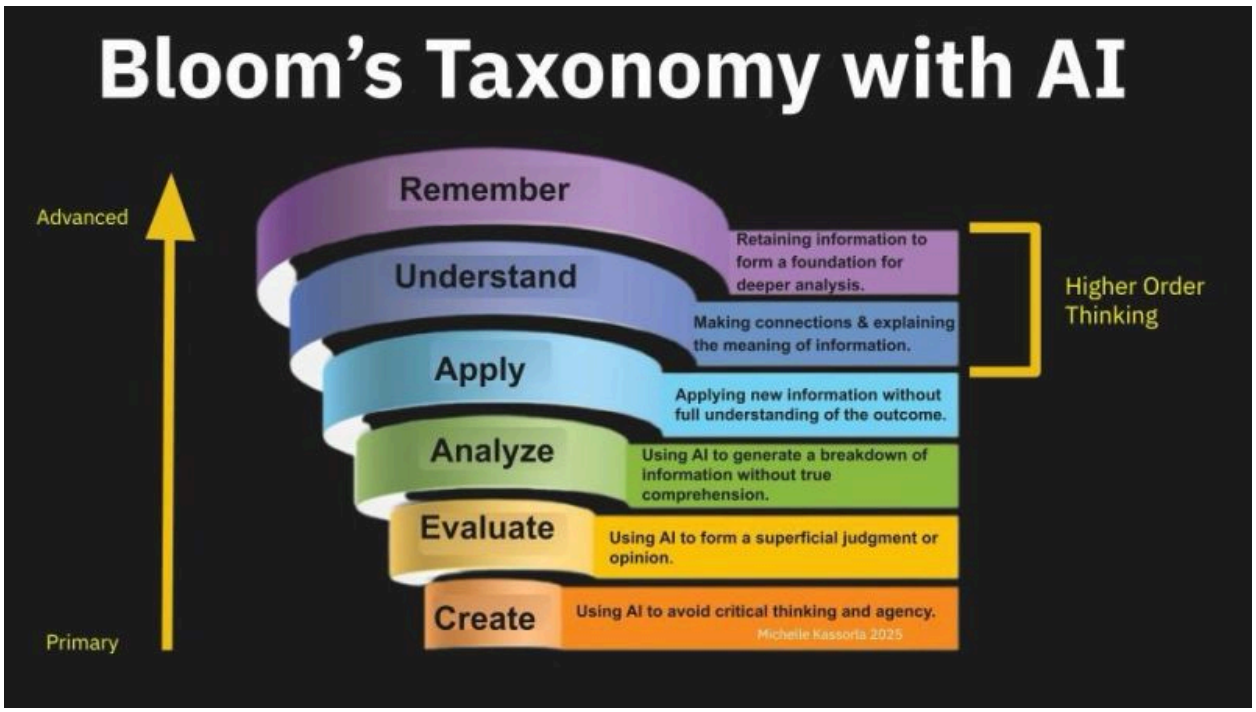
In addition to standard citation, teachers may require students to provide further information, including:

- **Clarification of Workflow**: Teachers may ask students to explain their workflow and specifically how AI tools were utilized. For example, a student might include a statement such as: "This essay was drafted with the aid of an AI writing assistant, specifically [AI tool name], for initial brainstorming and outline generation."
- **Show the Prompt**: Students may be required to document the exact prompt or questions provided to the AI tool within their assignment submission, perhaps in an appendix or as a footnote.
- **Include the Conversation**: For more extensive AI interaction, students might be asked to attach the full AI-generated conversation or interaction log as an appendix to their assignment submission.

Bloom's Taxonomy and AI



In the age of generative AI, traditional learning models like Bloom's Taxonomy are being re-evaluated. Dr. Michelle Kassorla (2025) proposes an "Inverted Bloom's" model, where students now often start with **creation**—using AI tools to generate essays, images, or code—before fully developing understanding or critical analysis. This inversion shifts the teacher's role from content deliverer to learning architect, guiding students to **critically evaluate** and **revise** AI outputs, reflect on their accuracy and ethics, and deepen their own comprehension. Rather than view this change as a threat to academic integrity, Kassorla encourages educators to see it as an opportunity to focus instruction on **higher-order thinking skills**—such as synthesis, metacognition, and judgment. This model aligns with research in educational technology and constructivist theory, which supports learning as a reflective, iterative process. Teachers can structure assignments that require students to justify or critique AI-generated responses, making their thinking visible and encouraging ownership of ideas. This approach ensures AI serves as a **scaffold**, not a substitute, for authentic learning.

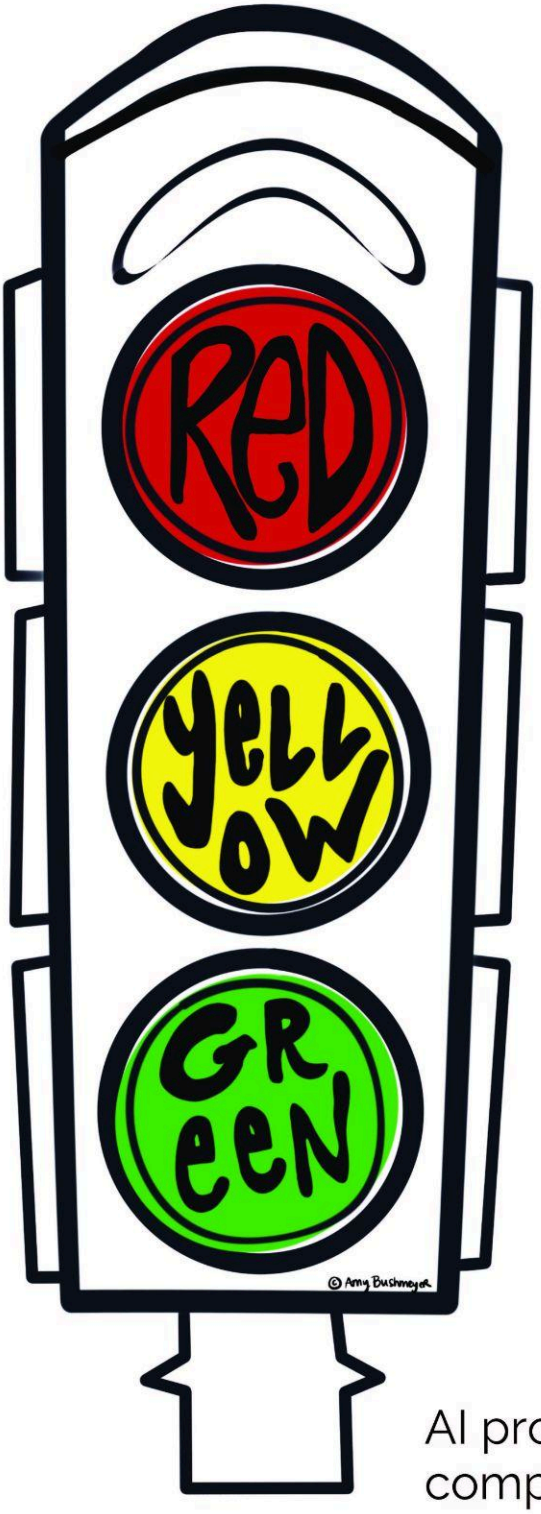

Bloom's Taxonomy with AI
Advanced
Primary
Remember
Retaining information to form a foundation for deeper analysis.
Understand
Making connections & explaining the meaning of information.
Apply
Applying new information without full understanding of the outcome.
Analyze
Using AI to generate a breakdown of information without true comprehension.
Evaluate
Using AI to form a superficial judgment or opinion.
Create
Using AI to avoid critical thinking and agency.
Michelle Kassorla 2025
Higher Order Thinking

Reference Materials, Research, Publications, and Articles Used

The development of this plan was informed by the following resources:

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AI (artificial intelligence) CLASSROOM GUIDELINES



RED

Do NOT use **AI.**

The use of AI for this assignment is not permitted.

YELLOW

Some **AI** use MAY be allowed.

Check with your teacher for specifics. Follow the guidelines set for the assignment.

GREEN

AI is allowed to be used as a tool.

AI programs should be used as a tool to complement learning, not replace it.